

also available, for 10,000 bucks (16 GB). I don't like the interface, as the touch screen controls are quite iffy and takes getting used to. One plus is the presence of an SD memory card slot – expansion is good, especially since 16 GB SD cards are rather cheap. Although the D2+ is small, it's pretty thick. Cowon's iAudio 5 was also available with the same vendor. Now this is a sweet little music player. It's really compact and looks like a small cellphone. If you're looking

for good quality music on a lower budget, the 4 GB version of the iAudio 5 costs just 4,600 bucks. It's got FM Radio and a voice recorder as well. I recommend this for someone looking at a good music player, but remember that the screen is just too small for video playback.

It seems Transcend and YES are taking the entry-level market by storm – YES has quite a few neat models ranging from Rs. 1,500 to Rs. 4,000 and if memory serves, they sound pretty good. Build quality is not a problem too. However, if you're spending around 4,000 bucks, you might as well pick up the Cowon iAudio 5. The iPod Classic is also available for Rs. 15,000 – 160 GB is a lot of space and this player sounds amazing – highly recommended for those with loads of music and cravings of quality. The Classic is bulky, but that's to be expected since it's HDD based. Samsung also has a few good PMPs, but none of the electronics shops had any.

I was attracted to the new iPod Touch – Apple's interface just rocks and the Touch is an amazing player – photos, high-quality music, videos – it's got all the goodies. The 64 GB version can store quite a bit and was my choice, but the price, an astronomical Rs. 24,800 wasn't to my liking. The 16 GB Nano was priced at Rs. 13,500, while the 32 GB Touch was priced at Rs. 16,900. I ended up with the latter and managed to swing it for 400 bucks less. Finally, I can carry around my photos, view them in style and all while tuned in to my grooves. The clincher for me was the interface really, everything is so seamless on the Touch and another important point was the decent browser – Safari. My home is Wi-fied, and I intend to use this to surf when in bed!



iPod touch

